NOVACART

Customer Support & Service Operations Policy Manual

A fictional, self-contained policy pack for a customer-support AI coaching demonstration

Document details	Policy value
Company	NovaCart — fictional online retail and digital-services company
Version	1.0 — demo policy
Effective date	21 October 2026 (fictional)
Applies to	Customer-support agents, team leads, quality reviewers, and AI training simulations
Purpose	Provide consistent rules for refunds, orders, delivery, payments, accounts, technical support, privacy, complaints, and escalation

Important: NovaCart and all policy timelines, amounts, service levels, and procedures in this manual are invented for a project demonstration. They are not the policies of a real company and are not legal advice. Do not present them as real commercial terms.

Designed for retrieval-augmented generation (RAG): headings, explicit rules, thresholds, exceptions, and escalation triggers are written so a knowledge base can retrieve the relevant passage for a customer scenario.

Contents

Section	Topic
1	Purpose, scope, values and support channels
2	Service levels, identity checks and case notes
3	Orders, order changes and cancellations
4	Shipping, delivery, missing parcels and tracking
5	Returns, refunds, exchanges and damaged/incorrect items
6	Payments, invoices, promotions and billing disputes
7	Account access, passwords and account security
8	Technical support and troubleshooting
9	Customer communication, angry customers and accessibility
10	Privacy, data handling and information security
11	Escalation matrix, complaints and exceptions
12	Service recovery, goodwill and compensation limits
13	Simulator scenarios and agent decision guide
14	Approved response templates
15	Glossary and policy quick-reference

This manual is intentionally broad. For any real company, replace the fictional rules with approved policies before deployment.

1. Purpose, scope, values and support channels

This manual defines the default customer-support process for NovaCart. The goal is to resolve routine issues consistently, protect customer information, and identify situations that require a specialist or supervisor.

1.1 Service principles

- **Be clear:** explain what is known, what will happen next, and when the customer should expect an update.
- **Be empathetic:** acknowledge inconvenience without blaming the customer or promising an outcome that has not been confirmed.
- **Be accurate:** use order records and approved policy rules; do not invent shipment status, refund completion, stock availability, or exceptions.
- **Own the case:** if a transfer is necessary, summarize the issue and tell the customer what happens next.
- **Protect data:** request only the minimum information needed and never ask for passwords or one-time passcodes.
- **Keep commitments:** record any promised follow-up and complete it within the stated timeframe.

1.2 Support channels

- Chat: available every day, 08:00–22:00 local time. Outside these hours, customers may submit a message for the next support window.
- Email/web form: monitored on business days, 09:00–18:00 local time.
- Phone callback: available for verified billing, delivery, account-security, and accessibility needs when the case requires a spoken explanation.
- Social media: agents may acknowledge a public post, but must move order-specific or personal details to a private verified channel.

1.3 Scope

This policy covers retail orders, delivery, returns, payments, account access, basic troubleshooting, customer complaints, and agent conduct. It does not authorize agents to provide legal, medical, financial-investment, or cybersecurity-forensics advice. Those issues must be redirected or escalated to the appropriate specialist.

1.4 Policy hierarchy

Applicable law and binding regulatory requirements take priority over this fictional manual. A verified, approved product-specific policy takes priority over a general rule here. If two internal rules conflict or the correct rule is unclear, pause any irreversible action and escalate to a team lead.

2. Service levels, identity checks and case notes

2.1 Standard response and resolution targets

Case type	Initial response target	Next action / update target
Routine order, product, or tracking question	Within 2 business hours	Resolve or provide a clear next step within 1 business day
Refund or return request	Within 1 business day	Confirm eligibility and next step within 2 business days
Payment charged but order missing	Within 4 business hours	Investigate or route to Payments within 1 business day
Account locked or suspected compromise	Within 1 hour during support hours	Route to Account Security immediately
Safety risk, credible threat, or exposed sensitive data	Immediate triage	Follow urgent escalation procedure without delay
Complex complaint / external carrier investigation	Within 1 business day	Update at least every 2 business days while open

These are internal demo targets, not guarantees of actual service. If a target cannot be met, tell the customer the current status, reason if known, next action, and next update time.

2.2 Identity verification

- For general product questions, no identity verification is required.
- Before discussing order-specific details, verify at least two approved attributes, such as order number plus the email or phone number on the order.
- For changes to delivery address, payment details, account email, or account recovery, use the approved secure verification workflow.
- Never ask for a password, full card number, card security code (CVV), or one-time passcode. Do not ask a customer to send these by chat or email.
- If verification fails, do not reveal whether a specific email, phone number, or account exists. Explain the safe recovery route instead.

2.3 Case notes

- Record the customer's stated issue, verified identifiers needed for the case, relevant order or ticket number, actions taken, evidence reviewed, outcome, and next follow-up date.
- Separate confirmed facts from customer reports and agent assumptions.
- Do not record full payment credentials, passwords, authentication codes, unnecessary sensitive personal details, or insulting commentary.
- If an agent makes an error, correct the record transparently; do not silently alter a record to hide the mistake.

3. Orders, order changes and cancellations

3.1 Order confirmation and status

- An order is considered placed only when the system shows a confirmed order number and a successful order record.
- If a customer has a payment notification but no order confirmation, treat it as a payment/order mismatch and follow Section 6. Do not tell the customer the order is confirmed until the system confirms it.
- Explain the current status using the order record: received, processing, packed, shipped, delivered, cancelled, or under review.
- If the system is unavailable, say that status cannot yet be verified and provide a follow-up target. Do not guess.

3.2 Editing an order

- Before the order enters 'packed', an agent may request a product quantity or item change if the system supports it.
- Delivery-address changes are permitted only before carrier handoff and after identity verification. Once shipped, do not promise an address change; advise the customer to contact the carrier if that option is available.
- If the change cannot be completed in the system, explain the available alternatives: cancel and reorder if eligible, or wait for delivery and request a return if eligible.
- Never manually change a record outside approved tools or claim that a change succeeded without confirmation.

3.3 Cancellation rules

- Before packing begins: cancellation is normally allowed without a cancellation fee.
- After packing but before carrier handoff: request cancellation; it is pending until the system confirms it.
- After carrier handoff: the order cannot normally be cancelled through NovaCart support. Explain return/refusal options only if the carrier and product category permit them.
- Digital items or services that have already been redeemed or activated may be ineligible for cancellation; check the product-specific terms.
- If the customer was charged for a successfully cancelled order, explain that the payment reversal is handled under Section 6.

3.4 Out-of-stock, substitution and price mismatch

- Do not substitute an item without the customer's explicit consent.
- If an item becomes unavailable after order placement, offer a full refund for the unavailable item or an approved replacement at no additional cost, subject to customer choice and stock.
- If the displayed price differs from the confirmed order price, verify the order record and promotion terms. Do not promise a retroactive discount without approval.
- Escalate suspected pricing-system errors affecting multiple customers.

4. Shipping, delivery, missing parcels and tracking

4.1 Delivery estimates

- Standard delivery estimate: 3–7 business days after dispatch for domestic orders.
- Express delivery estimate: 1–3 business days after dispatch where offered and confirmed at checkout.
- Delivery estimates are estimates, not guaranteed arrival times, unless the order explicitly identifies a guaranteed service.
- Business days exclude weekends and published public holidays. Remote areas, weather, carrier disruption, and customs processing may extend delivery.

4.2 Delayed shipment

- If the tracking page shows movement within the last 48 hours, explain the latest scan and ask the customer to allow the next carrier scan unless the promised date has passed.
- If the estimated delivery date has passed and tracking has not updated for 48 hours, open a carrier investigation.
- If the shipment is 5 business days past the estimated delivery date, escalate to the Delivery team to consider replacement or refund under the case evidence.
- Do not claim the carrier lost the parcel until the carrier investigation or approved internal review supports that conclusion.

4.3 Marked delivered but not received

- Ask the customer to check the delivery location, building reception, household members, and any carrier photo or delivery note.
- If the parcel is still missing, open an investigation within 1 business day and provide the case reference.
- Do not require the customer to confront a neighbor or enter an unsafe location.
- For a high-value order, repeated claims, or conflicting delivery evidence, route to the Delivery Review team rather than promising an immediate refund.

4.4 Damaged parcel, missing item or wrong item

- Apologize and ask for the order number plus a concise description. Request photos only through an approved upload channel and only when needed.
- For visible damage, ask the customer to retain the packaging and item until the claim is reviewed; do not ask them to handle a potentially dangerous item.
- For a missing item from a multi-item order, verify shipment splits before concluding that the item is missing.
- For an incorrect item, confirm the received item and ordered item. Offer an approved return label and replacement/refund based on stock and customer preference.
- Escalate suspected product safety issues immediately; do not ask the customer to keep using the item.

4.5 Carrier limitations

Support agents cannot guarantee a carrier will reroute, intercept, or deliver at a requested time. Describe carrier options as requests, not confirmed outcomes, until the carrier system confirms them.

5. Returns, refunds, exchanges and damaged/incorrect items

5.1 Standard return eligibility

- Standard physical products may be returned within 30 calendar days of delivery if unused, complete, and in original condition, with proof of purchase.
- A return may still be considered for an item that arrived damaged, defective, or incorrect, even if the standard return window has passed; route for review rather than rejecting automatically.
- Final-sale, personalized, hygiene-sensitive, perishable, and activated digital products may have special restrictions disclosed at purchase. If the restriction is unclear, escalate.
- Do not deny a request solely because the customer lacks original packaging if the issue is damage, defect, or incorrect fulfillment; ask a team lead to review the case.

5.2 Return process

- Confirm order and item; check purchase date, product category, condition, and reason.
- Explain eligibility, any documented restriction, and whether the customer must return the item.
- If eligible, create a return authorization and provide the approved label or drop-off instructions.
- Do not tell the customer to ship to an unverified address or pay an unapproved return fee.
- Record the return authorization and explain what event starts the refund clock.

5.3 Refund timing

- After an approved return reaches the returns facility and passes the required check, NovaCart initiates the refund within 5 business days.
- The bank or payment provider may take an additional 5–10 business days to display the credit. Explain that this is a provider processing estimate, not a guarantee.
- For a cancelled order not yet shipped, the refund or authorization release is normally initiated within 3 business days after cancellation is confirmed.
- If the refund is marked completed but not visible after 10 business days, ask Payments to provide the transaction reference and investigate.
- Never state that a refund is completed merely because it has been requested or approved. Distinguish 'requested', 'approved', 'initiated', and 'posted by provider'.

5.4 Refund method and amount

- Refunds normally return to the original payment method. Agents must not redirect a refund to a different account or wallet without the approved verification process.
- Refund the amount actually paid for the eligible item, including applicable tax. Shipping charges are refunded when required by the relevant offer or when the error was attributable to NovaCart, subject to review.
- Promotional discounts are recalculated according to the original offer terms. Explain the calculation before finalizing if the amount differs from the item list price.
- Store credit may be offered as an optional alternative, but must not be forced on the customer in place of an eligible monetary refund.

5.5 Exchanges and replacements

- Replacement is available when the item is defective, damaged, incorrect, or otherwise approved and stock is available.
- If stock is unavailable, offer the eligible refund path or a waitlist/notification option if available.

- Confirm whether the customer must return the original item. Do not promise a replacement dispatch date until the order system confirms it.
- For repeated defects or safety concerns, escalate to Quality and Product Safety.

6. Payments, invoices, promotions and billing disputes

6.1 Payment status

- Use the payment system's status: pending/authorized, captured/paid, failed, reversed, refunded, or disputed.
- A pending authorization is not the same as a settled charge. Explain that the bank may display a pending amount until it releases the hold.
- If payment failed, advise the customer to verify with their bank or use an alternative approved payment method. Do not repeatedly retry a payment without the customer's consent.
- Never request full card details, CVV, PIN, password, or one-time passcode.

6.2 Charged but no order confirmation

- Verify the customer using approved identity checks and search for an order record.
- Check whether the payment is pending, captured, or reversed; do not assume a bank notification means NovaCart received the money.
- If no order exists and the payment is pending, explain the expected release process and provide a case reference if needed.
- If payment is captured but no order exists, route to Payments within 1 business day. Do not ask the customer to place a duplicate order until the risk of a second charge has been explained.
- If the same transaction appears twice, record transaction timestamps and amounts using approved secure tools and escalate as a duplicate-charge case.

6.3 Billing disputes and invoices

- Compare the invoice to the confirmed order, taxes, shipping, discounts, and any split shipment.
- If an amount is incorrect, explain the line items and correct a confirmed NovaCart error through the approved adjustment workflow.
- If the charge is unfamiliar or appears fraudulent, follow Section 7. Do not tell the customer to ignore it.
- Invoices and receipts must be sent only to the verified contact address on the account or through the secure account portal.

6.4 Promotions, coupons and store credit

- Check the promotion's expiry, eligible products, minimum spend, region, account restrictions, and whether codes can be combined.
- Do not invent coupon codes or promise that an expired promotion will be restored.
- If a coupon failed due to a confirmed system defect, document evidence and request an approved correction.
- Store credit is not cash and may have expiry or usage conditions disclosed at issuance. Explain those conditions before the customer accepts it.

7. Account access, passwords and account security

7.1 Password reset and locked accounts

- Direct customers to the official 'Forgot password' workflow or approved account-recovery page.
- Support agents must never ask the customer to tell them their password, share a one-time code, or approve an unexpected authentication prompt.
- If a reset email is not received, ask the customer to check spam/junk, confirm they are using the registered address through the secure workflow, and wait up to 10 minutes before retrying.
- If the account remains locked after two approved recovery attempts, route to Account Support; do not bypass security controls.
- Do not disclose whether an email address is registered unless the secure flow is designed to do so.

7.2 Suspected account compromise

- Treat unexpected password-reset messages, unknown orders, changed contact details, or unauthorized sessions as possible compromise.
- Route immediately to Account Security and advise the customer to use the official secure account recovery process from a trusted device.
- If available, recommend changing the password on the affected account and any other account using the same password, after regaining secure access.
- Do not investigate by asking for passwords, one-time codes, full card numbers, or remote access to the customer's device.
- Preserve relevant case references and timestamps. Do not promise recovery of funds or data before specialist review.

7.3 Profile changes

- Email, phone, delivery address, and payment changes require the approved verification workflow.
- For a lost phone or inaccessible email, use the documented alternate recovery path; do not override verification based on persuasion or urgency alone.
- Escalate conflicting identity evidence, suspected impersonation, or repeated attempts to change account ownership.

8. Technical support and troubleshooting

8.1 Standard troubleshooting sequence

- Clarify the issue: what the customer expected, what happened, when it started, and whether an error message appears.
- Determine scope: one device/account or multiple users; one feature or the entire service.
- Check the approved service-status page and known incidents before asking the customer to repeat steps.
- Offer low-risk steps in order: refresh or restart the app; check connectivity; update to the supported version; sign out and back in only if the customer can securely regain access.
- Ask for the exact error text or a screenshot with personal data hidden. Never request a screenshot that exposes passwords, one-time codes, payment credentials, or private messages.
- Record the steps tried and result so the customer does not have to repeat them after transfer.

8.2 Troubleshooting boundaries

- Do not ask customers to disable device security, install unapproved remote-control tools, share authentication codes, or run commands they do not understand.
- Do not recommend deleting data or resetting a device unless the consequence is explained and an approved backup/recovery route exists.
- If a step could remove saved data, affect payment, lock the account, or create a safety/security risk, stop and escalate.
- For a widespread outage, acknowledge the incident, share only the approved status update, and avoid making an individual customer repeat troubleshooting steps that cannot fix the outage.

8.3 Technical issue severity

- **Low:** cosmetic issue or one nonessential feature; normal support queue.
- **Medium:** a key feature is impaired for one customer but a safe workaround exists; technical queue within 1 business day.
- **High:** login or purchase function unavailable for many users, data loss suspected, or repeated failures; urgent technical escalation.
- **Critical:** suspected security breach, widespread exposure of customer data, or credible risk of harm; immediately notify the designated incident lead and follow security incident procedures.

8.4 Required technical case details

Record app/site version if known, device and operating system where relevant, timestamp and time zone, exact error message, steps already attempted, whether other users are affected, and any relevant incident ID. Collect only what is necessary.

9. Customer communication, angry customers and accessibility

9.1 Standard communication structure

- Acknowledge the issue and its impact.
- State the verified facts in plain language.
- Explain the action available under policy.
- Give the next step and a realistic update target.
- Ask one focused question at a time when more information is required.

9.2 Handling angry or frustrated customers

- Remain calm, professional, and concise. Do not argue, mirror insults, blame another team, or use sarcasm.
- Acknowledge emotion without admitting unverified fault: 'I can understand why the delay is frustrating. I'll check the latest status and explain the next step.'
- If the customer repeats a concern, summarize what has already been checked and what remains unresolved.
- Do not make a false promise simply to end the conversation. Explain policy limits and any escalation route.
- If abuse continues, set a respectful boundary and offer to continue when the conversation is constructive. Follow the threat procedure for credible threats.

9.3 Threats, harassment and safety

- Threats of physical harm, stalking, credible threats against staff, or statements indicating immediate danger must be escalated to the designated safety lead promptly.
- Do not disclose staff personal information, schedules, locations, or internal contact details.
- Agents may end a conversation only under the approved safety/abuse procedure and must record the reason.
- For imminent danger, follow the organization's emergency process and local emergency guidance; do not attempt personal investigation.

9.4 Accessibility and language

- Use plain language, explain acronyms, and offer an alternate channel when reasonable.
- Allow additional time or written follow-up for customers who need it, where the channel supports this.
- Do not assume a customer's technical ability, disability, language, or intent.
- When translation is needed, use approved tools and avoid sharing sensitive data with unapproved services.

10. Privacy, data handling and information security

10.1 Minimum necessary data

- Collect and use only information needed to verify the customer, resolve the issue, meet a documented business need, or satisfy an applicable requirement.
- Use approved systems to view customer records; do not copy customer information into personal notes, public forums, or unapproved AI tools.
- Do not disclose another person's order, contact information, account status, delivery details, or support history.
- Before sending an attachment or invoice, confirm the recipient through the approved workflow.

10.2 Prohibited information requests

- Never request passwords, PINs, one-time passcodes, full card numbers, card security codes, or account recovery codes.
- Never ask a customer to post sensitive personal information in a public channel.
- Never ask for remote access to a personal device as a routine support step.
- Do not ask for government ID unless an approved specialist process requires it and the secure upload method is provided.

10.3 Suspected data exposure

- If customer data is sent to the wrong recipient, exposed in a public post, or visible to an unauthorized person, stop further disclosure and notify the designated privacy/security lead immediately.
- Do not delete or alter evidence unless the incident lead directs it. Preserve the case reference, time, channel, and type of information involved without making unnecessary copies.
- Do not tell the customer that a breach has or has not occurred until the authorized incident team confirms the facts.
- Use only the approved customer-notification process.

10.4 Retention and deletion

Support records must be retained and deleted according to the organization's approved retention schedule and applicable requirements. Agents must not invent a retention period or promise immediate deletion if the request needs formal review. Route data-access, correction, or deletion requests to the privacy process.

11. Escalation matrix, complaints and exceptions

Trigger	Route to	Required agent action
Refund exceeds routine policy; disputed eligibility	Team Lead / Returns Review	Summarize purchase date, item, condition, reason, and policy point in question.
Payment captured but no order; duplicate charge; refund not posted after 10 business days	Payments	Record transaction references through approved tools; never collect full card credentials.
Parcel missing after delivery checks; repeated delivery failure	Delivery Review	Provide tracking status, dates, carrier evidence, and investigation reference.
Account takeover or unauthorized account changes	Account Security	Use secure recovery route; do not bypass verification.
Possible data exposure or security incident	Privacy/Security Incident Lead	Notify immediately; stop unsafe sharing and preserve case facts.
Widespread app outage, data loss, critical technical fault	Technical Incident Lead	Capture impact and error details; use approved status message.
Threats, harassment, or immediate safety concern	Safety Lead / Supervisor	Follow safety protocol; do not disclose staff details.
Customer requests legal interpretation or regulator complaint advice	Supervisor / Compliance	Record request neutrally; do not offer legal advice.
Policy conflict, unusual exception, or unclear rule	Team Lead	Pause irreversible action and explain that review is required.

11.1 Escalation handoff standard

- State the customer's goal and the issue in one or two sentences.
- Include relevant order/ticket reference, timeline, verified facts, steps completed, evidence available, and the exact decision needed.
- Tell the customer who or what team will review the case and when the next update is expected.
- Do not simply transfer a conversation without context when a summary can be provided.
- The receiving team owns the specialist decision; the original agent remains responsible for any follow-up they explicitly promised.

11.2 Formal complaints

If the customer says they want to make a formal complaint, record it as a complaint rather than treating it as ordinary feedback. Acknowledge receipt, provide the complaint reference, summarize the issue and requested outcome, and route it to the complaint owner. Do not discourage a customer from using an available complaint or regulatory channel.

11.3 Exceptions

Agents cannot waive eligibility requirements, alter refund timing, grant compensation above their limit, or bypass verification without documented authorization. A supervisor must record the rationale, approval, and any conditions. If the system or policy does not support a requested action, explain the limitation honestly.

12. Service recovery, goodwill and compensation limits

12.1 Approved recovery options

- A sincere apology and clear explanation.
- Priority follow-up within the applicable escalation path.
- Replacement, refund, or return label when policy eligibility is met.
- A one-time goodwill credit of up to ■500 per order may be approved by a team lead for a documented NovaCart service failure. This is a fictional demo limit.
- Amounts above ■500, repeated credits, cash-equivalent exceptions, or any compensation outside the approved tool require manager approval.

12.2 Goodwill rules

- Goodwill is discretionary, not automatic, and must be recorded with the reason and approving person.
- Do not use goodwill to conceal a safety, privacy, fraud, or systemic technical incident.
- Do not offer compensation in exchange for deleting a complaint, changing a review, or staying silent.
- Do not promise compensation before approval is recorded.

12.3 Fraud or abuse concerns

Repeated claims, inconsistent records, suspected payment fraud, or attempts to obtain another customer's information must be routed for review. Agents must not accuse the customer of fraud; state only that the case requires a standard review. Continue to provide appropriate service while protecting account security.

13. Simulator scenarios and agent decision guide

These scenarios are designed for AI coaching practice. The AI acting as a simulated customer should express a realistic need or emotion; the trainee should use this policy to respond. The system may retrieve relevant passages and suggest a policy-grounded answer.

Scenario	Customer opening / issue	Policy passages to retrieve	Expected trainee action
Refund request	“I returned my order last week. Where is my money?”	5.2–5.4; 2.3	Check return status; distinguish refund initiated from posted; explain timing and next update.
Late delivery	“My package is four days late and tracking hasn't changed.”	4.1–4.2; 11	Verify estimate and last scan; investigate if thresholds met; give reference and update target.
Marked delivered	“It says delivered, but nothing arrived.”	4.3	Suggest safe checks, open investigation, avoid unsupported refund promises.
Wrong item	“You sent the wrong product. I need the correct one.”	4.4; 5.5	Verify order/item; arrange approved replacement or refund path.
Double charge	“You charged me twice.”	6.1–6.2; 11	Check statuses and references; route suspected duplicate charge to Payments.
Password problem	“I can't log in and the reset email isn't coming.”	7.1	Guide official reset, spam check, wait, and escalate after two attempts; never request code.
Suspicious activity	“There are orders I didn't place.”	7.2; 10; 11	Treat as possible compromise; immediate Account Security route.
App error	“The app crashes every time I try to pay.”	8.1–8.3; 6	Check known outage, collect error details, avoid duplicate payment, escalate severity.
Angry customer	“Your company is useless. Fix this now.”	9.1–9.3; 11	Stay calm, acknowledge impact, state facts and next action; set boundary if abuse continues.
Privacy request	“Send me all the information you have about my account.”	10.1; 10.4; 11	Verify identity and route through formal privacy request process.
Order cancellation	“I ordered the wrong size. Cancel it.”	3.2–3.3	Check fulfillment stage; request cancellation if eligible; do not claim success until confirmed.
Promotion failed	“Your coupon doesn't work. Give me the discount.”	6.4; 11	Check terms and system evidence; request approved correction if confirmed defect.

Agent decision rule: verify → classify the issue → retrieve the relevant policy → explain the allowed action → record the case → escalate if a trigger is met. If the policy does not answer the question, say what is unknown and ask for review rather than inventing a rule.

14. Approved response templates

14.1 Acknowledge and investigate

“I'm sorry this has been inconvenient. I'll check the available order details and confirm what we can do next. Could you share your order number? Please don't send passwords, one-time codes, or full payment-card details.”

14.2 Delayed delivery

“I understand you were expecting the parcel by now. The latest status I can verify is [status] as of [time/date]. I'll [next action] and update you by [target time]. I can't confirm a new delivery date until the carrier provides one.”

14.3 Refund initiated

“Your refund is marked as initiated on [date]. Your payment provider may need an additional 5–10 business days to show the credit. If it hasn't appeared after that period, reply with case reference [reference] so we can investigate.”

14.4 Password reset

“For your security, please use the official ‘Forgot password’ option. Check your spam folder and allow up to 10 minutes for the email. Please do not share any password or one-time code with me. If recovery still fails after two attempts, I can route this to Account Support.”

14.5 Angry customer

“I can hear how frustrating this has been, and I want to help move it forward. Here's what we've confirmed: [facts]. The next step is [action], and I'll update you by [time].”

14.6 Policy exception needed

“I want to give you an accurate answer. This request needs a review because it falls outside the actions I can approve directly. I've sent the details to [team], and the next update is expected by [time/date].”

14.7 Service outage

“We're aware of an issue affecting [service, if confirmed]. The technical team is investigating. I don't have a confirmed restoration time yet, but the approved status page is [location]. I'll avoid asking you to repeat steps that won't address the current incident.”

14.8 Complaint acknowledgement

“I've recorded this as a formal complaint under reference [reference]. The complaint owner will review [short summary]. The next update is expected by [time/date]. You can tell me if there's a specific outcome you'd like us to consider.”

15. Glossary and policy quick-reference

Term	Meaning in this manual
Authorized / pending payment	A payment hold or authorization that may not yet be a settled charge.
Captured payment	A payment recorded as taken by the payment system.
Refund requested	A request has been submitted; it is not necessarily approved or sent.
Refund initiated	NovaCart has sent the refund instruction to the payment provider.
Refund posted	The payment provider displays the credit to the customer.
Business day	A weekday excluding weekends and published public holidays.
Escalation	Routing a case to a team with the authority or expertise needed to decide it.
Formal complaint	A complaint explicitly raised as a complaint, requiring a reference and designated owner.
Minimum necessary data	Only the information required for the task or approved process.
RAG	Retrieval-augmented generation: retrieve relevant document passages and use them to ground an AI response.
Simulator mode	AI plays the customer; trainee practices the support response.
Manual mode	Trainee enters a customer issue and reviews retrieved policy passages and a suggested response.
Replay mode	A saved session is reviewed from its stored conversation history; replay should not invent new events.

Quick decision checklist

- Have I verified the identity required for this action?
- What facts are confirmed by the system, and what is only reported or assumed?
- Which policy section applies, and does it explicitly support the action?
- Am I making a promise that the system cannot confirm?
- Have I avoided asking for passwords, one-time codes, and full payment credentials?
- Have I recorded the case and set a realistic next update?
- Is an escalation trigger present?

End of manual. This fictional document is intended for AI Coaching Assistant development, RAG retrieval tests, and simulated customer-support training. Review every rule before adapting it to a real organization.